

Gophish Simulated Phishing Campaign Report

Gophish

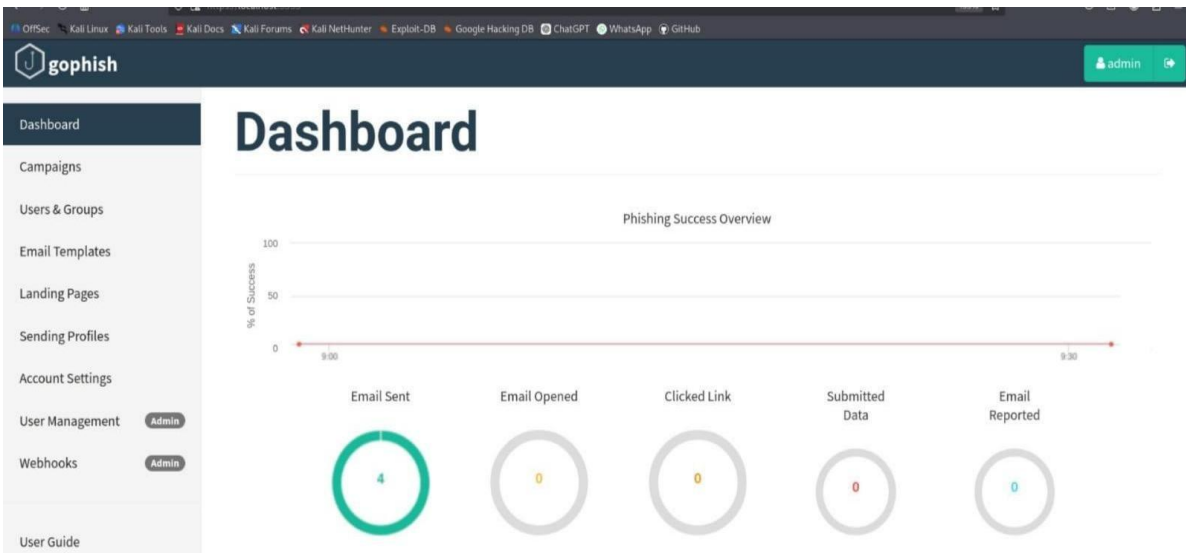
Gophish is a free, open-source toolkit for running phishing simulations. It enables security teams to craft realistic phishing emails, host deceptive landing pages, and monitor recipient behaviour tracking opens, clicks, and any submitted data.

Executive Summary

This document describes a controlled phishing simulation conducted with the Gophish platform on a Kali Linux virtual machine. The test was carried out in an isolated environment with explicit permission and aimed to measure staff susceptibility to social-engineering attacks, verify detection and response mechanisms, and produce practical recommendations to reduce human risk. The process from scoping and template creation to deployment, monitoring, and analysis was recorded and illustrated with screenshots from the Gophish dashboard and the target VM.

Setup and Dashboard

Gophish was operated via its web dashboard on the Kali VM. The dashboard delivers a campaign overview and email metrics (such as sent, opened, clicked, submitted, and reported) to track campaign progress in real time.



User Groups created

Within the **Users & Groups** area, a test cohort of accounts was created to serve as the campaign targets.

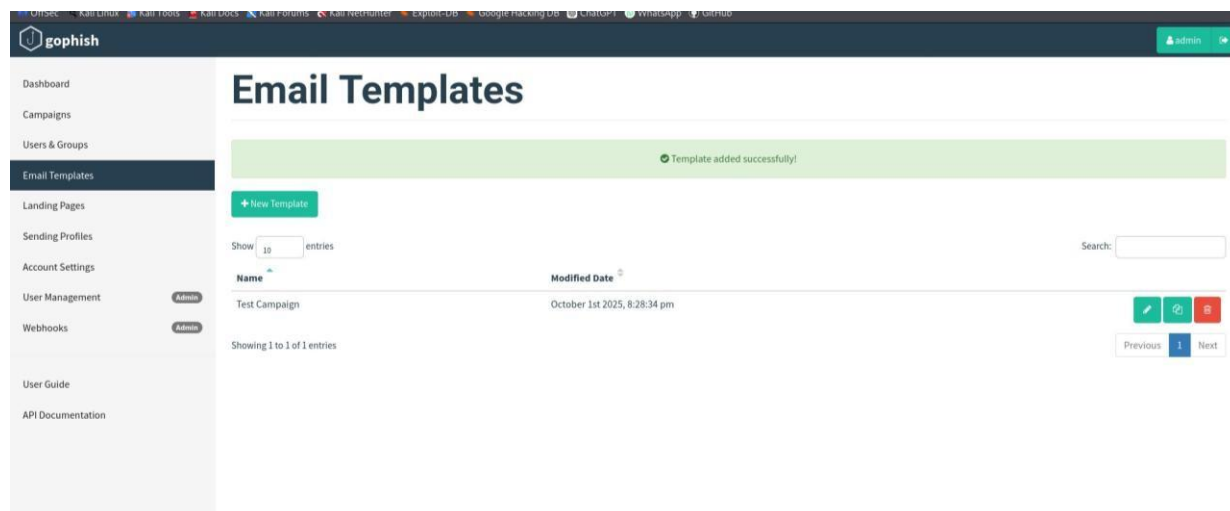
The screenshot shows the Gophish Users & Groups page. A green banner at the top indicates "Group added successfully!". Below this, there is a "New Group" button and a "Show 10 entries" dropdown. A table lists the created groups, and a search bar is available on the right. The table shows one entry: "testgroup" with 1 member, created on October 1st 2025 at 8:22:24 pm.

Name	# of Members	Modified Date
testgroup	1	October 1st 2025, 8:22:24 pm

Showing 1 to 1 of 1 entries

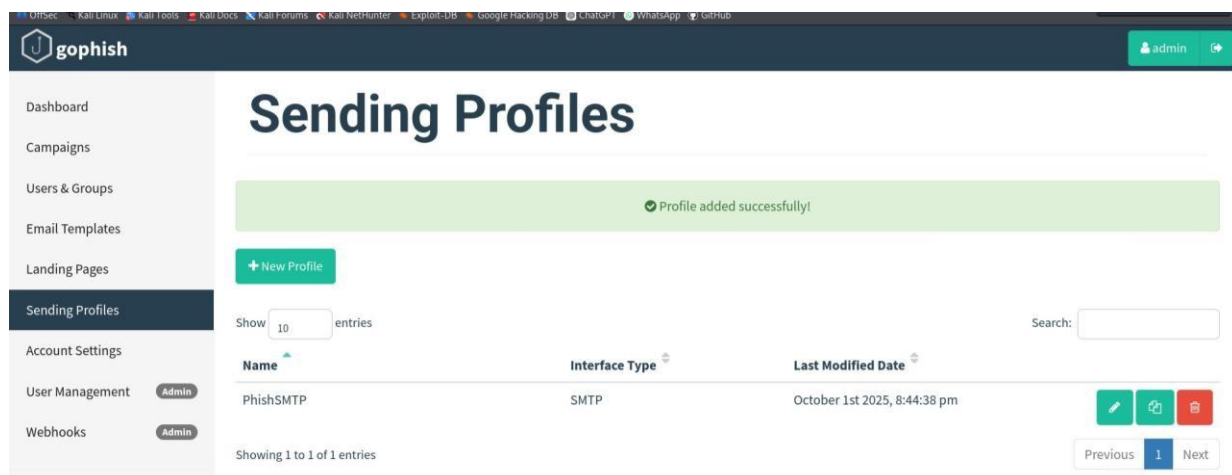
Email Template Creation

An email template was developed in the **Email Templates** section. The message was crafted to appear urgent and professional in order to entice recipients into following the malicious link.



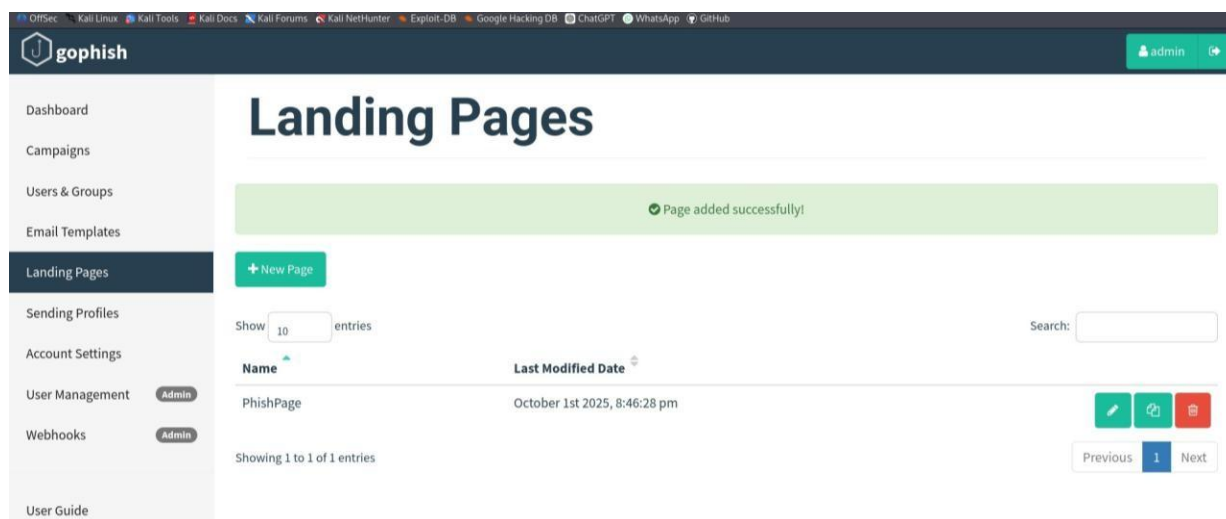
Sending Profile Configuration

A sending profile was configured with SMTP settings so that the phishing messages seemed to originate from a legitimate sender increasing the believability of the emails.



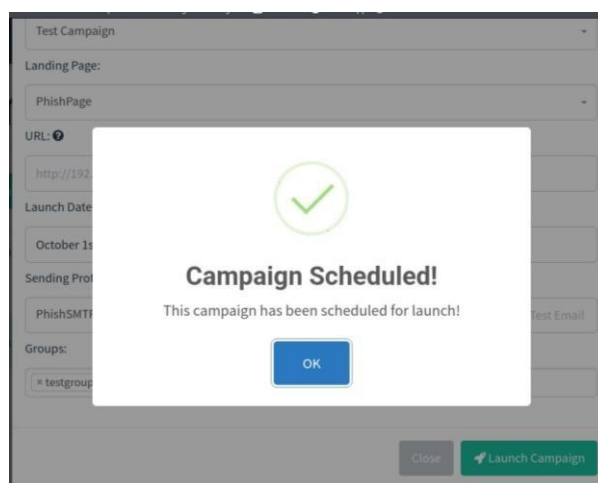
Landing Page Design

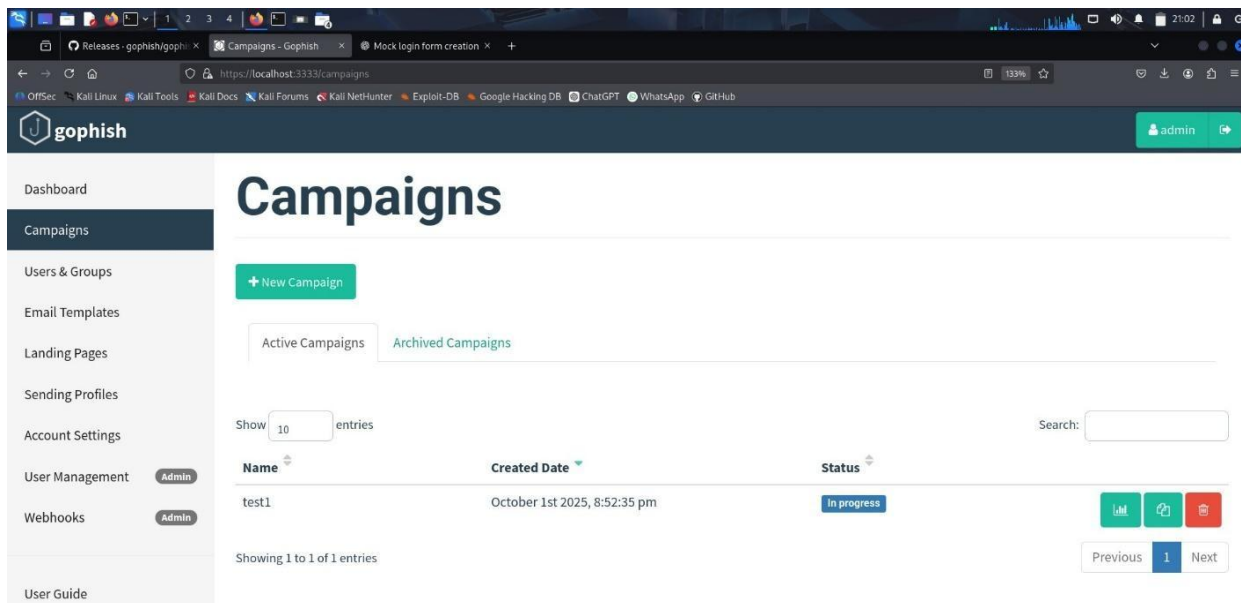
A bespoke landing page was built to capture credentials. Recipients who clicked the phishing link were taken to this page and encouraged to enter sensitive information.



Campaign Creation and Execution

A phishing campaign was launched using the configured group, template, sending profile, and landing page. The campaign ran successfully and allowed live tracking of user interactions.





Conclusion

The Gophish exercise showcased the entire phishing lifecycle from building groups, templates, and landing pages to observing recipient interaction. It revealed both technical and human weaknesses, identifying individuals more likely to engage with phishing content. The simulation underscored the need for ongoing awareness training, stronger email defenses, and well-defined testing procedures, and produced concrete recommendations for improving the organisation's resilience to phishing.